SINGAAR – MVP Scope

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Summary

SINGAAR is a Zomato for looks. Independent women artists, small salons and established studios each list their packages and prices and show their work from Instagram. A bride in Chennai or Bangalore browses, filters and compares them side by side, opens a profile, checks that her date is free and sends a booking request. If she does not know what she wants, she describes the look in her own words and AI suggests who to see. The provider confirms the request.

Name and brand. "Singaar" means adornment. The brand uses dark sindoor red and gold, with a logo of a bindi inside a gold ring and the wordmark SINGAAR in spaced capitals.

The problem in one line. Small salon owners and independent women artists in Bangalore and Chennai lose bridal bookings to big parlours because customers cannot easily find, compare or trust them, and brides cannot tell what a fair price is. The problem statement submitted in the portal is unchanged. This scope reads it as a discovery and trust problem, which is what my mother's salon and the Reddit evidence show.

Status. A clickable prototype is built (see section 9) with sample profiles and sample prices. Nothing in it is presented as real data.

Evidence and positioning

The facts about call-only customers and lost bridal bookings come from my mother's salon. That is one salon, so it is a case and not a sample. Everything else about users comes from three Apify datasets (Reddit posts, Google results, G2 reviews; see Sources). The Reddit owner evidence is from r/hairstylist, which is mostly US, so owners in Bangalore and Chennai beyond my mother's salon are a GAP – needs research. Section 9 sets out how I will close each gap.

Labels used throughout. Prices from public listings are "sample". Only owner-confirmed prices are "verified". Numbers from vendor or company sites are marked "vendor figure". A claim the data does not support is marked "GAP – needs research".

Who else is in this space

Product	What it does (from public pages)	How SINGAAR differs, to be tested
WedMeGood	A bridal vendor directory by city. Artist pages show a bridal price per function, "Paid Vendor" markers and trial options (WedMeGood Bangalore). How vendors pay: not found.	The closest competitor. SINGAAR focuses on independent women artists and small salons, shows packages side by side for the same look, and adds describe-your-look. Whether this is enough: GAP – needs research.
Fresha marketplace	Customers discover salons, compare services and book. A source reports a 20% commission on new clients (Zenoti roundup, a vendor blog). A G2 reviewer was billed a share even when bookings fell through (review). Whether its marketplace operates in Bangalore or Chennai: GAP.	Commission only on completed bookings is a hypothesis for SINGAAR. Built for Indian bridal looks and for artists who work solo.
Urban Company	At-home services. Fixed prices for routine services, the platform assigns the professional, and commission is	Different model. SINGAAR lists the artist or salon the customer chooses, with her own prices and her own work.

Product	What it does (from public pages)	How SINGAAR differs, to be tested
	estimated at 20–30% (StartupTalky; sources disagree).	
YesMadam	Salon at home. The system auto-assigns the nearest professional; service charges start at ₹6 per minute (YesMadam Bengaluru, YourStory).	Different model. No bridal price list was found on its page.
Justdial	A directory. Chennai shows "10395+ Listings" for bridal makeup artists (vendor figure; the snippet is garbled) (Justdial).	A listing without comparable packages, portfolio or date check.

1. Problem

Small salon owners and independent women artists in Bangalore and Chennai lose bridal bookings to big parlours because customers cannot easily find, compare or trust them, and brides cannot tell what a fair price is.

Owners and artists

- From my mother's salon: customers contact her only by phone call. She loses bridal bookings to big parlours because customers feel a small, cheaper salon is not worth it. She charges a little less than other salons.
- "I've had dozens of no shows/late cancellations in my career and I've always had a policy where I charge." (r/hairstylist)
- "Hello, this is my 35th year doing hair and I have never seen so many gaps in my book." (r/hairstylist)

The two owner quotes describe no-shows and empty books at US stylists. The enquiry-time problem rests on my mother's salon alone: GAP – needs research for other Bangalore and Chennai owners.

Customers and brides

- "Both times I struggled to find a good makeup artist and was nervous even when I found one." (r/IndianMakeupAddicts)
- "I asked around and people quote insanely high prices." (r/Chennai)
- "Ask for quotes before telling your budget. Since this is an unregulated industry, they will not have fixed charges." (r/Chennai comment)

2. Current State

Customer

1. Ask around or post a request. "I asked around and people quote insanely high prices." (thread)
2. Look through directories and social pages. Justdial lists "10395+ Listings" for Chennai bridal makeup artists (vendor figure) (Justdial). WedMeGood lists Bangalore artists (WedMeGood). Instagram rate pages appear in Google results (Instagram).
3. Ask for referrals and check work, and collect quotes one by one.
4. Do trials. "try as many muas as you can. Go for trials" (thread). One bride was "unable to attend frequent trails" (thread).
5. Contact and book. At my mother's salon customers phone. For other Bangalore and Chennai providers: GAP – needs research.

Owner (first case: my mother's salon)

1. A customer phones. Customers do not write messages.
2. She answers and quotes by phone. Enquiries per week and minutes per enquiry vary, with no fixed figure.
3. She tracks appointments by call only. She takes no advance or deposit.
4. She reminds past clients only when she sees them in person.
5. She charges a little less than other salons, and loses bridal bookings to big parlours.

Owners elsewhere (r/hairstylist, mostly US) use software or an appointment book (thread), send automated texts (thread) and rebook by hand past the online limit (thread).

Tools mentioned. Owners: Vagaro, Acuity, Square, GlossGenius, Schedulicity, Booker (thread, thread). Customers: Reddit, Justdial, WedMeGood, Instagram, itsmy.wedding. Indian salon software vendors appear in Google results (DINGG, Salonify), but a vendor listing is not evidence that owners use it.

Why owners may not use existing tools. My mother uses only phone calls. Why owners in Bangalore and Chennai do not use Fresha, Zenoti, Salonist or WhatsApp Business is the question my mentor raised and the data does not answer: GAP – needs research. It is the first question in the owner interviews (section 9).

3. Opportunity

The data holds no weekly frequency and no hours-per-task figure, so the time side is a GAP. Money and scale figures below are vendor figures unless marked.

Frequency of enquiries. Enquiries per week at my mother's salon vary with no fixed figure: GAP – needs research.

Time per task. Minutes per enquiry vary, and the Google search for time spent on bookings returned none: GAP – needs research.

Value of a bridal booking

The ₹15,000–₹20,000 in my problem statement means the price of one bridal makeup booking (the wedding-day look), not a yearly figure per client. The ranges below are for one booking and vary with the style and with whether a package includes other functions.

Source	Figure	Type
Problem statement	₹15,000–₹20,000 per bridal booking	Unsourced starting point
itsmy.wedding	Chennai: ₹15,000–₹30,000 for HD, ₹8,000–₹15,000 traditional	vendor figure
saybridalstudio.in	Chennai: ₹15,000–₹50,000	vendor figure
WedMeGood	Bangalore: 15,000–30,000 per function	vendor figure
The Monsha's	India: ₹7,000–₹20,000 for pro artists	vendor figure
Reddit comment	Chennai: "20-35k is the range for a fairly popular MUA for both reception and wedding."	Customer report

People affected and market

- Chennai: "10395+ Listings" for bridal makeup artists on Justdial (vendor figure; a listing count, not active artists) (Justdial).
- Bangalore artists and salons, and Chennai salons: GAP – needs research.

- India beauty salon market: USD 11.65 billion in 2024 (Lakme Salon, Custom Market Insights), vendor figure, national rather than city-level.
- "Wedding season is 40% of many Indian salons' revenue." (EaseSeat), vendor figure.
- Cost of finding customers: ₹5,000–₹15,000 a month on Instagram ads, or 20–30% commission to aggregator apps (Bewtee), vendor figure.

Signal in Reddit. Of 156 scraped Reddit items, 23 posts were relevant. By theme: 9 posts say customers can't find or choose a salon or artist, 5 describe no-shows, 5 describe unclear or high prices, 5 describe booking-software gaps, and 3 describe too few bookings. Themes overlap, and these are counts of posts, not people.

4. Solution

A bride browses, filters and compares artists, salons and studios in one place, opens a profile, checks her date and sends a booking request. The provider lists herself once and answers requests from one inbox. Tags show what the MVP builds (MVP) and what waits (Later).

Customer

Step	Status	Replaces today
Search by city, look (bridal, engagement, reception, saree draping, hair, bridesmaids, mehendi), budget and date.	MVP	Asking around
Or describe the look in her own words; AI turns it into filters and shows the best matches first.	MVP	Not knowing what to ask
See cards for independent artists, small salons and studios with the price for that look, her styles, area and whether she is free on the date.	MVP	Scanning many directories
Tick up to three and compare packages and prices side by side.	MVP	Collecting quotes one by one
Open a profile: packages with prices, portfolio from Instagram, date check.	MVP	Hunting through social pages
Send a booking request for her date. The provider confirms.	MVP	Phoning each provider
Pay a deposit and book online; reminders; callback request.	Later	Calls
Review after a completed booking.	Later	Unverified ratings
Attend the trial or event.	Stays manual	n/a

Salon, artist and freelancer (first case: my mother's salon)

Step	Status	Replaces today
List herself once: name, city, area, Instagram handle, packages and prices. Confirmed prices become verified.	MVP	No online presence
Receive booking requests in one inbox, with the date, look and budget.	MVP	Phone calls only
AI drafts the reply wording; she approves or edits it. Prices come from her own list.	MVP	Writing each reply and quote
Log a phone enquiry by typing what the caller said.	MVP	Memory

Step	Status	Replaces today
Unanswered requests expire after 48 hours.	MVP	Forgotten enquiries
Calendar with blocked dates; calls and reminder lists; reviews.	Later	n/a
Freelancer onboarding with human vetting, for artists who style on weekends or part-time.	Later	No way to be found
Deliver the service and mark it completed.	Stays manual	n/a

What disappears. For customers: asking around and scanning directories, Instagram and Reddit to compare prices. For providers: writing each reply from scratch and looking up numbers.

What stays manual. The phone call itself at my mother's salon, judging a portfolio, trials, the provider's approval of each reply and quote, and delivering the service. Logging a call is a new manual step; whether she will do it is GAP – needs research.

5. AI Thinking

AI is used only where the input is free text or the output is wording. Everything that is a lookup, a number or a timer is a rule or a script. AI never sets or changes a price.

Step	AI, human or rule	Why
Search by city, look, budget, date	Rule	A database filter. Do not use AI.
Show each price as sample or verified	Rule	A flag set when the provider confirms a price.
Describe-your-look text to filters and a style match	AI	One sentence can mix the city, several functions, saree draping, a style and a budget (example). A filter form cannot parse that. Accuracy on Tamil and Kannada words: GAP – needs research.
Compare side by side	Rule	A table built from each provider's own list.
Date check	Rule	A lookup of the provider's blocked dates.
Reply wording to a booking request	AI draft, provider approves	The reply depends on the date, functions and travel; a template cannot cover that.
Quote numbers in the reply	Rule	Taken from the provider's verified price list. A script blocks any draft whose numbers do not match.
Phone enquiry notes to a structured request	AI	Free text again.
48-hour expiry	Script	A timer. Do not use AI.
Approving every reply and quote	Human	The provider decides what the customer sees.
Listing quality	Human	A person reviews each profile and portfolio before it goes live.

If AI were removed: the product would still list and compare providers, but a bride who cannot name what she wants, and a provider who must write every reply, would be back to guessing and typing. That is the

job AI does here. Whether describe-your-look beats the plain filters for most brides: GAP – needs research, and it is tested in section 9.

6. Architecture

Three flows. Claude appears in one stage of each; rules, a script and the provider's approval sit between it and the customer.

Flow 1: search and describe-your-look

Input	AI/model	Logic	Action/tools	Output
City, look, budget, date; or a free-text description	Claude turns free text into city, look, budget and style words	Rules filter providers, check dates, attach sample or verified to each price, rank by style match	Vercel app reads providers from Supabase	Cards with prices and availability; optional "why this match"

Flow 2: booking request and provider reply

Input	AI/model	Logic	Action/tools	Output
Customer date and look; provider's price list	Claude drafts the reply wording only	Script checks every number in the draft against the verified list and blocks a mismatch; 48-hour timer	n8n receives the request, stores it in Supabase and notifies the provider	Provider approves or edits; customer sees the confirmed reply

Flow 3: list yourself, and log a call

Input	AI/model	Logic	Action/tools	Output
Name, city, Instagram handle, packages, prices; or typed call notes	Claude structures call notes into a request	Required fields and duplicate checks; a person reviews each new profile	Vercel form to Supabase; n8n queues the review	A live profile, or a logged enquiry in the inbox

7. Impact

Time saved per user per week: GAP – needs research. Enquiries per week and minutes per enquiry at my mother's salon vary with no fixed figure, and no source in the data gives hours per task. I will fill the blanks from owner interviews and from two weeks of logged enquiries.

Hours per week = Σ (count per week × minutes each) ÷ 60. Time saved = hours per week now − hours per week after.

Task	Per week now	Minutes each now	Per week after	Minutes each after
Handling an enquiry	___	___	___	___
Writing a quote or reply	___	___	___	___

For a call-only owner the MVP may save nothing on the calls themselves, and logging a call adds a step. Any saving would come from reply writing: GAP – needs research. A bride's time spent comparing providers is also unmeasured: GAP – needs research.

Quality. Customers say "they will not have fixed charges" (comment). The MVP shows packages and prices in one layout, each labelled sample or verified, and every reply is approved by the provider. A measure to track: the share of drafted replies a provider sends without edits. No baseline exists: GAP – needs research.

Scale. Chennai shows "10395+ Listings" for bridal makeup artists (Justdial, vendor figure). Bangalore and the number of owners in both cities: GAP – needs research. The MVP starts with my mother's salon and the providers I can reach from her network.

Revenue scenario for a provider (a scenario, not a finding)

Bridal bookings recovered per month × price per booking. I chose 1 to 3 bookings. How many my mother's salon loses to big parlours each month is GAP – needs research.

Price per booking	1 booking	2 bookings	3 bookings
₹15,000	₹15,000	₹30,000	₹45,000
₹20,000	₹20,000	₹40,000	₹60,000
₹30,000	₹30,000	₹60,000	₹90,000
Her verified price	___	___	___

₹15,000–₹20,000 is from the problem statement (unsourced). ₹30,000 is the top of the Bangalore range (WedMeGood, vendor figure). Bookings cluster in wedding season, which is "40% of many Indian salons' revenue" (EaseSeat, vendor figure), so do not multiply by 12.

Platform revenue scenario (illustrative rate, not a finding)

Aggregators are said to charge 20–30% (Bewtee, vendor figure). SINGAAR's hypothesis is a lower commission charged only on completed bookings. The table uses 10% only to show the arithmetic; the real rate is to be tested with owners.

Price per booking	Commission at 10%	Provider keeps
₹15,000	₹1,500	₹13,500
₹20,000	₹2,000	₹18,000
₹30,000	₹3,000	₹27,000

8. Limitations

Failure cases, each with the check a human makes:

Failure	Evidence	What a human checks
A wrong or misleading price	"Since this is an unregulated industry, they will not have fixed charges." (comment). Public listing prices can be garbled: the Justdial snippet for Chennai talks about Mumbai and "Rs. 0,000".	The provider confirms her own prices. Sample prices stay labelled sample. A person compares sample and verified prices.
A date shown as free that is not	"System would occasionally double book clients." (G2 review); booking an	Every request says the date is subject to the provider's

Failure	Evidence	What a human checks
	artist in wedding season is “very difficult” (thread).	confirmation, and the provider confirms when she approves.
A poor-quality or fake listing	“I do not know how this salon has such high rating with such sub-par service.” (thread); “most of these mua do not have any credentials to begin with” (comment).	A person reviews each profile and portfolio before it goes live. Reviews wait for v2.
An empty marketplace (no providers or customers yet)	No source in the data. This is the standard risk of any marketplace.	Start with my mother’s network in one area and bridal only; count live profiles weekly.
Stale prices that nobody updates	No source in the data.	Prices older than 90 days are flagged to the provider; the provider confirms or edits.

Biggest open risks. (1) Adoption: owners may not list or keep a profile, which is the mentor’s first question. (2) At my mother’s salon customers phone and do not write, so a free-text box may not match her customers, and a bride may prefer to call. Reddit shows some brides writing requests (thread), but Reddit users are a different group. (3) WedMeGood already lists bridal artists with prices, so SINGAAR must show a reason to switch. All three are GAP – needs research and are tested in section 9.

What to build next. See LATER in section 9. First, run the validation plan, then add the calendar, reviews and freelancer onboarding.

9. MVP scope

The MVP is one core journey with three features: a bride finds and compares providers, opens a profile and sends a booking request, and the provider lists herself and answers.

Magic moment. A bride describes the look she wants and sees independent artists, small salons and studios side by side, each with the price for that look and whether she is free on her date.

IN (three features)

1. **Browse and compare.** Search by city, look, budget and date; describe-your-look; listing cards; side-by-side comparison of up to three providers.
2. **Profile and booking request.** Packages with prices, portfolio from Instagram (placeholders in the prototype), date check, booking request that the provider confirms.
3. **Provider side.** List yourself with packages and prices; an inbox of requests and logged calls; AI-drafted reply wording that the provider approves; prices always from her own list; 48-hour expiry.

OUT (mentioned, not built)

Real WhatsApp, payments and commission, reviews, reminders and call lists, deposits, freelancer vetting and gigs posted by salons.

LATER (v2)

Freelancer profiles and vetting for weekend and part-time artists; reviews after completed bookings; calendar with blocked dates; reminders and bring-back call lists; deposits and online booking; real WhatsApp; commission only on completed bookings (a hypothesis to test); regional-language support; more cities and looks beyond bridal.

Tech stack

Tool	What it does
Claude	Reads the describe-your-look text and call notes, and drafts reply wording. Never supplies a price.
n8n	Runs the workflows: receives requests, applies the rules and the 48-hour timer, calls Claude, writes records, queues profile review.
GitHub	Holds the code, prompts and rules, and deploys to Vercel.
Vercel	Hosts the web app: browse, profiles, compare, the provider form and inbox.
Supabase	Stores everything that is written: providers, price lists, requests and replies.

Prototype

A clickable prototype shows the browse-and-compare experience: a sindoor-red home page with the SINGAAR logo, search and filters, ten sample profiles across Chennai and Bangalore, a profile page with packages and a date check, side-by-side comparison, a describe-your-look box, and a “list yourself” form. A first clickable version is already built. Its link is submitted with the build link, and the working app follows the same journey.

- **Real in the prototype:** search, filters, ranking, comparison, date check and the listing form.
- **Sample in the prototype:** all ten profiles, their prices and their Instagram handles. Prices are labelled sample.
- **Simulated:** booking requests send nothing, portfolio tiles are placeholders, and describe-your-look matches words to the sample profiles instead of calling AI.

Business model (hypotheses to test)

Hypothesis	What I assume	How I test it
Free to list in the pilot	Providers list at no cost while there are few customers.	Count how many of the owners I reach complete a profile.
Commission only on completed bookings	A rate below the 20–30% said to be charged by aggregators (vendor figure).	Ask five owners what they would pay per completed booking.
Featured placement later	Studios and salons may pay to appear first.	Not tested yet: GAP – needs research.

Go-to-market: the first listings

Start with my mother’s salon and the owners and artists she knows, in one area of one city, bridal only. The target is ten live profiles. Each profile needs a name, an area, an Instagram handle and at least three packages with prices confirmed by the provider.

Validation plan

These are my targets, not findings. Each one has a question, a method and a pass signal.

Question	Method	Pass signal (my target)	When
Why do owners not use Fresha, Zenoti, Salonist or WhatsApp Business?	Five owner interviews, recorded	At least three give a clear reason I can design around	Before the 23 Oct pitch

Question	Method	Pass signal (my target)	When
Would an owner list herself, and what would she pay?	Same five interviews	At least three would list; a price range is given	Before the 23 Oct pitch
Is ₹15,000–₹20,000 the price of one bridal booking, and how many are lost each month?	Ask my mother and the five owners	A real number per owner, noted as one owner's figure	Before the 23 Oct pitch
Do brides prefer comparing to asking around?	Short customer videos	Most say comparing prices is the hard part	Before the 23 Oct pitch
Will brides type a description, or prefer filters or a call?	Watch five people use the prototype	At least three finish a search without help	After the prototype demo

Sources

Every Apify dataset and link used in this document. Anything not listed here is either a GAP or comes from my mother's salon (primary source, a single case, provided by the founder).

Primary source. My mother's salon: call-only customers, bridal bookings lost to big parlours because cheaper feels lesser, no advance or deposit, slightly lower prices, reminders in person only. A single case, not a market finding. Her real price list is not yet in, so no price in this document is "verified".

Apify datasets

Source	Actor	Dataset ID	Run ID	Notes
Reddit r/IndianMakeupAddicts	trudax/reddit-scraper-lite	SFkU2C18ayGETj0US	fzPmr5sCLQjMlpF26	Customer and bride posts
Reddit r/hairstylist	trudax/reddit-scraper-lite	XaLgdOHhNRzE0xnBK	VM8yRbaLpRH5AJ4Lk	Owner posts, US-centric
Reddit r/bangalore	trudax/reddit-scraper-lite	xWI6DQ1kCs1rewuBM	CcE2uuzf7QhNRM6pg	
Reddit r/chennai	trudax/reddit-scraper-lite	KRNvhUoigGs7Tw0W3	4piLf6wwEXOynrJsA	
Google results (5 queries, 1 page each)	apify/google-search-scraper	GvapmQ1bLhfQkoHx3	GTYF57cnfqGNdF79l	AI Overviews ignored
G2 reviews (Fresha 2, Zenoti 20)	automation-lab/g2-scraper	FZvMpqfDYuFzM83RI	jo0SNrDwTNe6LuCrV	Lowest rating first
G2 product search, Fresha	automation-lab/g2-scraper	7reYZOyX0OvrpTtur		
G2 product search, Zenoti	automation-lab/g2-scraper	Dp4spKTIUVUoM5Nn4		

Links: Reddit

- r/hairstylist: no shows and late cancellations
- r/hairstylist: major appointment book gaps
- r/hairstylist: appointment scheduling and client records
- r/hairstylist: online booking, how far out
- r/hairstylist: booking systems for solo stylists
- r/hairstylist: booking and appointment apps
- r/IndianMakeupAddicts: good makeup artists are hard to find
- r/IndianMakeupAddicts: doing your own bridal makeup
- r/Chennai: search for good bridal makeup artists
- r/Chennai: MUA 2024
- r/Chennai: comment on bridal quotes
- r/bangalore: disappointing manicure experience

Links: Google results and public pages

- Justdial: bridal makeup artists in Chennai
- WedMeGood: Bangalore bridal makeup
- itsmy.wedding: bridal makeup artist in Chennai
- Say Bridal Studio: bridal makeup price in Chennai
- The Monsha's: bridal makeup price in India
- Instagram: Bangalore makeup artist rates
- Lakme Salon: industry overview
- Custom Market Insights: India beauty salon market
- EaseSeat blog
- Bewtee: where to list beauty services
- DINGG: salon management software
- Salonify: salon software features

Links: competitors and G2

- Urban Company business model (StartupTalky)
- YesMadam: salon at home in Bengaluru
- YourStory: YesMadam growth
- Zenoti: best beauty salon appointment apps 2026 (vendor blog)
- G2: Fresha review
- G2: Zenoti review

Figures from vendor blogs and market-report pages are "vendor figures"; prices from public listings are "sample".